





GUIDANCE DOCUMENT



RELIANCE FOUNDATION
POSTGRADUATE SCHOLARSHIP

Welcome!

Thank you for your interest in the Reliance Foundation Postgraduate Scholarships.

This guidance document is designed to help you understand the application process and prepare a complete, thoughtful, and competitive application. We encourage you to read it carefully before beginning your application.

For detailed policy-related questions, please refer to the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs).

ABOUT THE RELIANCE FOUNDATION POSTGRADUATE SCHOLARSHIPS

The **Reliance Foundation Postgraduate Scholarships** aim to identify and support India's brightest postgraduate students, enabling them to pursue higher education with confidence and realize their full potential.

The scholarship is designed for students who demonstrate academic excellence, leadership potential, integrity, and a commitment to creating meaningful impact in society. By supporting exceptional talent across diverse fields of study, the programme seeks to nurture future leaders who will contribute to India's growth and development.

Selected scholars receive **financial assistance of up to ₹6 lakh** over the duration of their postgraduate programme. However, the scholarship extends well beyond financial support.

MORE THAN A SCHOLARSHIP

A Lifetime Community of Leaders

The Reliance Foundation Postgraduate Scholarship is much more than financial assistance—it is an opportunity to become part of one of India's most vibrant and diverse communities of young changemakers.

As a Reliance Foundation Scholar, you will join a network of talented students representing different states, cultures, disciplines, and institutions across the country. This community offers opportunities to learn from one another, collaborate on ideas, and build lifelong friendships and professional networks.

Throughout your scholarship journey, you will gain access to:

- Leadership and personal development programmes
- Skill-building workshops and masterclasses
- Expert interactions with leaders across industries
- Mentorship opportunities
- Volunteering and social impact initiatives
- Regional Scholar Meets and networking events
- Exclusive learning opportunities and partner benefits
- A lifelong Reliance Foundation Scholar and Alumni Community

Together, these experiences are designed to help you grow—not only as a student, but also as a confident leader and responsible citizen.



THE VALUES WE LOOK FOR

The Reliance Foundation Undergraduate Scholarships seek students who demonstrate the following values:

Excellence

A commitment to achieving your best in academics and beyond, while continuously striving to improve.

Leadership Potential

The ambition and ability to create meaningful impact and inspire positive change.

Integrity

Honesty, accountability, and responsibility in your actions and decisions.

Community Commitment

A desire to contribute towards improving communities and society.

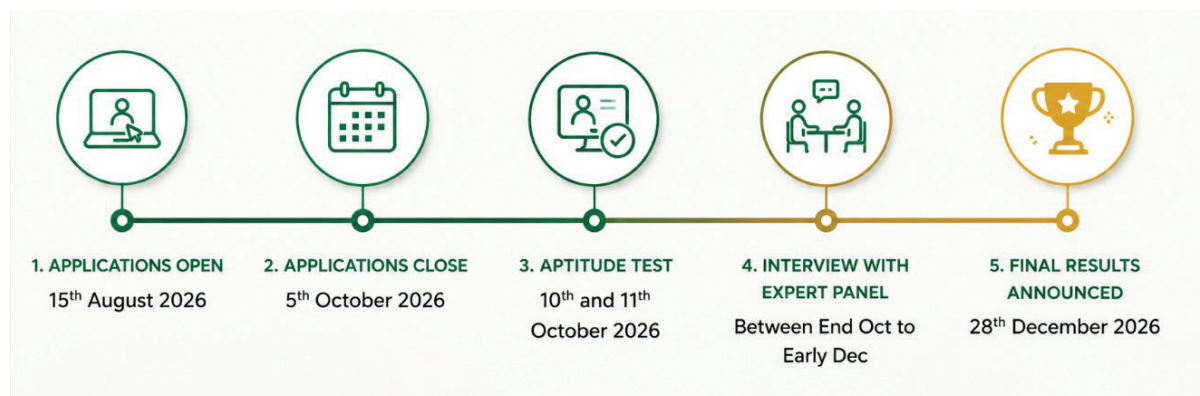
Growth Mindset

Curiosity, resilience, adaptability, and a willingness to continuously learn.

Courage

The determination to overcome challenges with perseverance and optimism.

SCHOLARSHIP TIMELINE



BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Before starting your application, please keep the following ready:

- Personal email ID
- Active mobile number
- Aadhaar Card
- Undergraduate marksheets
- Graduation degree/provisional certificate (if applicable)
- Current postgraduate admission/enrolment proof
- Family income details (if applicable)
- Passport-size photograph
- Relevant supporting documents

Please use your **personal email address** while registering. Institute email IDs may restrict important communication related to your application.

COMPLETING YOUR APPLICATION

Personal Details

- Enter your name exactly as it appears on your official identity documents.
- Ensure all information matches your supporting documents.
- Verify your mobile number and email address carefully.

ACADEMIC DETAILS

Provide accurate details of your undergraduate education and current postgraduate programme.

Please ensure:

- Academic scores match your official transcripts.
- Degree and institution names are entered correctly.
- All mandatory fields are completed accurately.

STATEMENT OF PURPOSE

The Statement of Purpose is one of the most important parts of your application.

Use this section to help us understand:

- Your academic journey
- Career aspirations
- Why you chose your field of study
- The problem you wish to solve
- How the scholarship will help you achieve your goals

Write honestly and authentically. We encourage you to reflect your own experiences, motivations, and aspirations rather than using generic or AI-generated responses.

SCHOLARSHIP APTITUDE TEST

All eligible applicants are required to complete an online aptitude test.

The assessment evaluates your abilities across areas such as:

- Verbal Ability
- Analytical & Logical Reasoning
- Quantitative Ability

The test is designed to assess your aptitude and problem-solving abilities required for postgraduate education.

A practice test will be made available before your scheduled assessment to familiarise you with the platform.

BEFORE YOUR TEST

- Attempt the mock test.
- Use a laptop or desktop wherever possible.
- Ensure a stable internet connection.
- Keep your camera and microphone enabled.
- Choose a quiet environment.

DURING THE TEST

Do

- Keep your face visible throughout the assessment.
- Stay in full-screen mode.
- Complete the assessment independently.
- Follow all instructions displayed on the platform.

Don't

- Open other applications or browser tabs.
- Leave the test window.
- Seek assistance from another person.
- Allow conversations or distractions in the background.

ACADEMIC & CHARACTER REFERENCE LETTERS

Reference Letters

As part of your application, you are required to submit two reference letters.

These letters help us understand your academic potential, character, leadership qualities, and overall suitability for the Reliance Foundation Postgraduate Scholarship.

You must submit:

Academic Reference (1)

This letter should be written by someone who has directly taught and assessed you academically, such as:

- University Professor
- College Faculty Member
- School Teacher (if applicable)
- Coaching Institute Faculty (if relevant)

Your referee should be able to comment on your academic abilities, intellectual potential, and preparedness for postgraduate study.

Character Reference (1)

This letter should be written by someone who has closely supervised or worked with you outside the classroom and can comment on your character, leadership, and community engagement.

Suitable referees include:

- Internship Supervisor
- Employer or Manager
- Research Supervisor
- NGO or Volunteer Coordinator
- Sports or Extra-curricular Mentor
- Teacher who knows you beyond academics

Choosing the Right Referee

Choose referees who know you well and can provide meaningful, specific recommendations.

Your referees should:

- Know you personally and professionally
- Be willing to write a detailed recommendation
- Be currently associated with an organisation
- Have access to an official letterhead or institutional stamp

Former professors or supervisors are also acceptable. They may mention their previous designation (for example, Former Professor or Ex-Manager).

Who Cannot Be a Referee?

The following are not accepted as referees:

- Family members or relatives
- Friends or classmates
- Senior or fellow students
- Public figures who do not know you personally
- Employees of Reliance Foundation

Registering Your Referees

You must nominate your referees through the online application portal.

Once you register them:

- They will automatically receive an email containing a secure link to upload their recommendation.
 - Please ask your referees to check their Inbox as well as their Spam/Junk folder.
 - We recommend using your referee's personal email address (such as Gmail or Yahoo) instead of an institutional email ID, as institute firewalls may block automated emails.
-

Reference Letter Requirements

Each recommendation must:

- Be written in English
- Be on the organisation's letterhead
- Be signed by the referee
- Be uploaded in PDF format

If a referee does not have access to a letterhead, the letter must carry the official organisation stamp.

Please note that unsigned letters or letters without a letterhead/official stamp will not be accepted.

Important Information

- Reference letters are confidential.
- Applicants cannot upload recommendation letters themselves.
- Once submitted, a reference letter cannot be edited.
- You may replace a referee before submission by removing them from your application and nominating another referee.

You can track the status of your references (such as *Pending* or *Submitted*) from your application dashboard.

Professional Profile

This section helps us understand your academic journey beyond grades.

Professional Experience

List up to **eight** internships, jobs, research projects, or other relevant professional experiences, beginning with the most recent.

For each experience:

- Mention your role and organisation.
- Provide the duration.
- Briefly describe your responsibilities and key learning.
- Upload supporting documents, such as internship certificates or employment letters.

Focus on experiences that demonstrate your growth, skills, and readiness for postgraduate study.

Awards & Achievements

Highlight significant achievements from your undergraduate education and recent years.

Include:

- Academic distinctions
- Competitions
- Leadership positions
- Innovation challenges
- Scholarships
- Recognitions

Supporting documents are optional.

Scholarships, Grants & Fellowships

Provide details of any scholarships, grants, fellowships, fee waivers, or stipends you have received or currently hold.

Please include:

- Scholarship name
- Award year
- Duration
- Scholarship value

Do **not** include scholarships you are currently applying for or awards that you declined.

If you receive a stipend during the scholarship period, please note that stipends from other sources are permitted up to **₹15,000 per month**, subject to programme policy.

Supporting documents may include:

- Scholarship award letter
- Institute offer letter
- Fee waiver letter
- Stipend sanction letter

Extra-curricular Activities

Tell us about activities outside academics where you have made a meaningful contribution.

Examples include:

- Sports
- Music
- Theatre
- Debate
- Volunteering
- Student clubs
- Community service

Clearly mention your role, responsibilities, and impact.

Publications, Presentations & Exhibitions

If applicable, provide details of:

- Research publications
- Conference presentations
- Technical papers
- Patents
- Exhibitions
- Creative work

Briefly describe your contribution and the significance of the work.

Supporting documents are optional.

Supporting Documents

Before submitting your application, ensure that all mandatory documents are ready.

Mandatory Documents

- Passport-size Photograph
- Address Proof
- Current Resume (maximum two pages)
- Class 10 Marksheet
- Class 12 Marksheet
- Undergraduate Transcript/Marksheet
- Bonafide Certificate or Fee Receipt
- Two Reference Letters (Academic & Character)

Additional Documents (if applicable)

- Internship/Employment Certificates
- GATE Scorecard
- Disability Certificate

Academic Transcripts

Upload complete academic transcripts for all undergraduate studies.

Ensure that each transcript clearly displays:

- Your name
- Institution name
- Programme details
- Academic results

Failure to upload the required academic records may result in your application being considered incomplete.

Photograph Guidelines

Upload a recent passport-size colour photograph.

Your photograph should:

- Have a white background
- Clearly show your full face
- Be in JPEG format
- Be under 2 MB
- Have good lighting and image quality

Essays

Your essays are an opportunity for us to understand **who you are beyond your academic achievements**.

We encourage you to write honestly, reflect deeply, and let your authentic voice come through.

Essay 1

Personal Statement

Your Personal Statement should help us understand:

- Your background and personal journey
- Experiences that have shaped you
- Challenges you have overcome
- Your values and motivations
- Leadership experiences
- Career aspirations
- Why you believe you are a suitable Reliance Foundation Scholar

Rather than repeating information already provided elsewhere in your application, use this essay to tell your story.

Maximum Length: 4,000 characters

Essay 2

Statement of Purpose

Your Statement of Purpose should explain:

- Why you have chosen your postgraduate programme
- What motivates your academic interests
- Your future career aspirations
- The impact you hope to create
- How this scholarship will help you achieve your goals

You may also discuss:

- Areas you wish to specialise in
- Skills you hope to develop
- Leadership opportunities you plan to pursue
- How you intend to contribute to your university and wider community

The questions provided in the application are intended only as prompts—you are not expected to answer each one separately.

Maximum Length: 4,000 characters

Tips for Writing Strong Essays

- Be authentic and write in your own voice.
 - Use specific examples from your experiences.
 - Reflect on your learning and growth.
 - Focus on impact rather than listing achievements.
 - Keep your writing clear, concise, and well-structured.
 - Review your essays carefully before submitting.
-

Common Errors to Avoid

To ensure a smooth application process, please avoid the following:

- Creating more than one application.
- Waiting until the last day to submit your application.
- Using your institute email ID.
- Uploading blurred or incomplete documents.
- Entering incorrect academic or income details.
- Missing your aptitude test.
- Forgetting your login credentials.

What Happens After Submission?

After submitting your application:

1. Submit your Bank Account and PAN details.
 2. Complete the online aptitude test.
 3. Applications will undergo evaluation and document verification.
 4. Selected scholars will be informed through registered communication channels.
 5. Scholarship grants and onboarding details will be shared with successful candidates.
-

Need Assistance?

If you require any support during the application process, please reach out to us:

Website: scholarships.reliancefoundation.org

WhatsApp: Send "Hi" to 7977 100 100

Helpline: (011) 4117 1414

Email: RFPGScholarships@reliancefoundation.org

All the best with your application!

